

Karen Bowers

Senior Applied Scientist

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Senior Applied Scientist with 15 years in Data/AI/ML, currently at Shopify. I work at the point where architecture meets delivery: setting technical direction, then staying close enough to the code to know whether it held. Strongest in Pandas, Airflow and PyTorch.

QUALIFICATIONS

Bachelor, Biology

South Cheryl Institute of Technology | 2010

GPA 3.8/4.0

EXPERIENCE

Shopify — Senior Applied Scientist

Feb '20 – Present

- Translated ambiguous business questions into a modelling roadmap with product and finance stakeholders.
- Established offline/online evaluation parity, catching 4 silent regressions before release.
- Developed an NLP classification system in TensorFlow reaching 92% F1, replacing a manual review queue.
- Cut inference cost by 15% through quantisation, batching and autoscaling on Azure.

Data Scientist, Amber Creek Software

Apr '13 – Dec '19

- Productionised demand forecasting models that reduced stock-outs by 40% across 12 regions.
- Lifted recommendation click-through by 45% through feature engineering and retraining cadence in PyTorch.
- Trained and deployed Scikit-learn models serving 10M predictions per day at under 80ms p95.

Applied Scientist, Spotify

Mar '12 – Feb '13

- Migrated ad-hoc notebooks into versioned Scikit-learn pipelines with reproducible runs and tracked experiments.
- Wrote the team's model documentation and review standard, now required before any production launch.

Palantir — Data Scientist

Jul '11 – Dec '11

- Built the feature store that 12 downstream models now read from, ending duplicated feature logic.
- Mentored 6 analysts moving into modelling work, with weekly paper reading and code review.

Machine Learning Engineer, Ironwood Consulting

May '10 – May '11

- Built an end-to-end training pipeline on Spark, cutting retraining from days to 40 hours.
- Reduced label noise by redesigning the annotation guidelines, improving validation accuracy by 15%.

CONTACT DETAILS

sandrahickman@example.net

207.797.0509x75451

linkedin.com/in/karen-bowers

github.com/karendev

SKILLS

Pandas • Airflow • PyTorch • Kafka •
Scikit-learn • TensorFlow • Spark •
Python • Azure • SQL • Rust •
PostgreSQL

References available upon request.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) — ISC2, 2017

Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) — Microsoft, 2024

